Plan 6 · Amritsar, Dalhousie, Dharamshala & Bir

Golden Temple and the Wagah retreat, Dalhousie–Khajjiar–Dainkund snow, McLeodganj and the Triund ridge, Norbulingka, Palampur tea, Baijnath, Bir (paragliding capital), plus the restored Kangra Valley toy train. 6 people · Airbnb · 24 Dec 2026 – 3 Jan 2027

At a glance

Route	Hyderabad → Delhi day → overnight train → **Amritsar** 1N → **Dalhousie** 2N (Khajjiar, Kalatop, Dainkund) → **McLeodganj** 2N (Triund) → Palampur–Baijnath → **Bir** 1N (NYE) → overnight bus → Delhi → Hyderabad
Why this plan	Mixes the best of Punjab and western Himachal: the Golden Temple, a border ceremony, snow at Khajjiar/Dainkund, Tibetan McLeodganj and a ridge trek, tea gardens and paragliding. Little overlap with Plans 1–2, and less traffic than Manali at NYE.
Snow chances	Medium–high at Dainkund and Triund. Medium at Khajjiar (late Dec). Low at Dalhousie town and Bir. None in Amritsar
Crowd level	High at the Golden Temple and Wagah. Medium in McLeodganj. Low at Kalatop, Dainkund, Bir
Budget per person (6 people)	**≈ ₹19.1k shoestring** · **≈ ₹29.0k recommended** (incl. paragliding)
Temperatures	Amritsar 4–18 °C (dense fog mornings) · Dalhousie −2 to 9 °C · McLeodganj 1–12 °C · Triund −5 to 4 °C

Getting there and back

Hyderabad → Delhi on 24 Dec: board in Hyderabad, Kazipet, Warangal or Vijayawada

Train	Where you board (time)	Reaches Delhi	Runs	Fare / person (SL · 3A)	Use it for
12723 Telangana SF Exp	**Hyderabad Deccan 06:00** · Secunderabad 06:20/06:25 · Kazipet 08:03/08:05	New Delhi ~07:40–08:00 (25 Dec)	Daily	≈ ₹800 · ≈ ₹2,100	**Default.** Cheapest, boards in the city. Delhi day + night train/bus onward
12621 Tamil Nadu SF Exp	Vijayawada 03:50–04:05 · Warangal 06:50/06:52 · **Kazipet 06:55**	New Delhi **06:30** (25 Dec)	Daily	≈ ₹750 · ≈ ₹1,950 (from Kazipet)	**Fast option.** Catches the 07:40 Kalka Shatabdi → Shimla same evening
22691 Bengaluru–Nizamuddin Rajdhani	Secunderabad 07:00/07:10 · Kazipet ~08:50	H. Nizamuddin 05:30	Daily	3A ≈ ₹3,300–4,100 (meals incl.)	Fast and comfortable but ~2× the 3A fare
12625 Kerala SF Exp	Vijayawada ~10:10–10:55 · Warangal ~13:30 · **Kazipet 13:45**	New Delhi 13:30	Daily	≈ ₹750 · ≈ ₹1,950	Backup if 12723 is full (leave Hyderabad by 09:30 by bus)

Getting to Kazipet / Warangal / Vijayawada with 6 people: Kazipet and Warangal are ~140 km (2.5–3 h). TGSRTC buses run through the night from JBS/Uppal to Hanamkonda (≈ ₹200–300), or an Innova one-way ≈ ₹4,000–5,000 (≈ ₹750 pp). Vijayawada is ~275 km (5–6 h). Only worth it if Hyderabad quota is full, because you'd need an overnight bus on 23 Dec.

12723 halts in order (check availability to each): Hyderabad Deccan → Secunderabad → Kazipet → Ramagundam → Mancherial → Sirpur Kagaznagar → Balharshah → Chandrapur → Sevagram → Nagpur → Itarsi → Bhopal → Jhansi → Gwalior → Agra Cantt → New Delhi (~18 halts, ~1,680 km). Confirmed: HYB 06:00, SC 06:20/06:25, Kazipet 08:03/08:05, Ramagundam 09:28/09:30.

Waitlisted? Check every station and halt this way

1. Direct pairs. On IRCTC / ConfirmTkt / ixigo, search 24 Dec: HYB→NDLS, SC→NDLS, SC→NZM, **KZJ→NDLS, WL→NDLS, BZA→NDLS** (Kazipet, Warangal and Vijayawada have their own quotas). Note AVAILABLE / RAC / WL for every train above.

2. Every halt. If HYB→Delhi is WL, search the same train from HYB to each later halt (Agra Cantt, Gwalior, Jhansi, Bhopal, Itarsi, Nagpur). A shorter ticket can be AVAILABLE when the full one is WL. Ride to Agra, then any Agra→Delhi train or bus (2–3.5 h).

3. Book from the origin. For trains starting elsewhere (22691 from Bengaluru, 12621 from Chennai, 12625 from Thiruvananthapuram), search origin→Delhi and set **Boarding Point** = Secunderabad / Kazipet / Warangal / Vijayawada. You pay the full-route fare but get the origin's quota.

4. Split it. HYB→Nagpur + Nagpur→Delhi (30+ trains a day). Keep 2–3 h between them.

5. Tatkal on 23 Dec (AC 10:00, SL 11:00), 2 PNRs of 3 people each. Premium Tatkal costs more but confirms more often.

6. Tick Vikalp + auto-upgrade and only hold WL if it is under ~WL 20 (3A) / WL 40 (SL) this far out.

6 people = 1 PNR in general quota (max 6 passengers per ticket), but **Tatkal allows only 4 per PNR**, so Tatkal needs 2 bookings from 2 Aadhaar-verified IRCTC accounts at the same minute. Senior citizens get lower berths only in general quota.

The Delhi gap: use it, don't waste it

Delhi day on 25 Dec (Friday, Christmas): luggage + Old Delhi circuit. From New Delhi station take the Yellow Line 2 stops to Chandni Chowk. Leave bags at the Delhi Jn (Old Delhi) cloak room (≈ ₹30–60 per bag per day; bags must be locked).

Red Fort (₹35 Indians, opens 09:30, closed Mondays) → **Jama Masjid** → **Chandni Chowk** food (Paranthe Wali Gali, Old Famous Jalebi Wala) → **Gurudwara Sis Ganj**. Then the Metro to Central Secretariat for **Kartavya Path / India Gate**, **Agrasen ki Baoli**, **Connaught Place**. Christmas evening service at **Sacred Heart Cathedral**. Back at Old Delhi by 20:30.

Cost ≈ ₹600–900 pp (metro day pass ₹200, entries, food). Christmas crowds are heavy at CP and India Gate after 17:00.

Intermediate legs (cheapest that connect)

Leg	Option	Time	Approx cost / person
Delhi → Amritsar (25 Dec night)	Overnight sleeper trains from New/Old Delhi or Nizamuddin (e.g. 12903 Golden Temple Mail calls at Nizamuddin; several others leave ~21:00–23:30 and reach ~05:00–07:30). Pick one that leaves after 20:30	7–9 h	SL ≈ ₹350 · 3A ≈ ₹950
Amritsar → Dalhousie	Innova (≈ ₹6,000 one-way, ~5 h via Pathankot) or bus to Pathankot + HRTC to Dalhousie (cheaper, ~7 h)	5–7 h	≈ ₹1,000 (Innova ÷ 6) or ₹350 by bus
Dalhousie → McLeodganj	Innova (~120 km)	4 h	≈ ₹900
McLeodganj → Bir	Innova via Norbulingka, Palampur, Baijnath	3–4 h with stops	≈ ₹850
Bir / Palampur → Delhi (1 Jan night)	HRTC ordinary/Volvo from Baijnath/Palampur (also private Volvos from Bir)	11–13 h	₹800–1,400
Kangra Valley toy train (optional)	Narrow-gauge Pathankot–Joginder Nagar line, **restored June 2026**. Ride a short scenic stretch, e.g. Kangra/Nagrota → Paprola (Baijnath) on Day 8, with the Innova meeting you	2–3 h segment	₹20–50 (unreserved)

Kangra toy train timetable could not be confirmed online. Check at Kangra / Nagrota station or NTES (search 'Pathankot Joginder Nagar') a day before.

Back to Hyderabad by 3 Jan

Train	Leaves	Reaches Hyderabad	Runs	Fare (SL · 3A)	Fits 'home by 3 Jan'?
12724 Telangana SF Exp	New Delhi **16:00**	Hyderabad Deccan ~17:10 next day	Daily	≈ ₹800 · ≈ ₹2,100	**Leave 2 Jan → home 3 Jan evening**
22692 Nizamuddin–Bengaluru Rajdhani	H. Nizamuddin late evening (≈ 20:30–21:00, verify)	Secunderabad 17:10 arr next day	Daily	3A ≈ ₹3,300–4,100	Leave 2 Jan → home 3 Jan
12722 Dakshin SF Exp	H. Nizamuddin 22:50	Hyderabad Deccan ~03:50 on day 3	Daily	≈ ₹780 · ≈ ₹2,100	Leave 1 Jan night → home 3 Jan 04:00

Getting around as 6

Option for 6 people	Seats / luggage	Typical hill rate (2025–26)	Per person per day (÷6)	When to choose
Innova Crysta with driver	6–7 + roof carrier	₹4,000–5,500/day (min ~250 km) or ₹16–18/km, + tolls, parking, ₹300–500 driver night	≈ ₹750–1,000	Default for 6 with soft bags
Tempo Traveller 12-seater	Lots of room	₹4,500–7,500/day or ₹18–22/km	≈ ₹850–1,250	Heavy luggage; not allowed on some narrow roads / union areas
2 × Dzire / Etios	4 + 4	₹2,800–3,500/day each	≈ ₹950–1,150	Only if no SUV is available
Local taxi unions (Manali, Pahalgam, Gangtok, Joshimath)	Innova / Tavera / Sumo	Fixed rate cards per circuit	Varies	Mandatory for some circuits (Solang–Sissu, Aru–Betaab, Tsomgo)
Government bus (HRTC / JKSRTC / UTC)	Seats	₹1.5–3 per km	Cheapest	Long point-to-point legs (Shimla→Manali, Delhi→hills)

Day-by-day itinerary

Day 1 · Thu 24 Dec · Hyderabad → Delhi

• **06:00 12723 Telangana Express** (or 12621 from Kazipet 06:55 → New Delhi 06:30).

Stay: Train | **Day spend (per person):** ₹300 food

Day 2 · Fri 25 Dec · Delhi day → overnight to Amritsar

• Old Delhi circuit + India Gate + Sacred Heart (Christmas). Night train to Amritsar (SL).

Stay: Train | **Day spend (per person):** ₹700 Delhi + ₹350 train

Day 3 · Sat 26 Dec · Golden Temple · Jallianwala Bagh · Wagah retreat

• Golden Temple in the early morning (quietest) → langar → **Jallianwala Bagh** → **Partition Museum** (Town Hall) → heritage street.

• **Attari–Wagah Beating Retreat**: in winter it starts around 16:15–16:30; reach by 14:30 with ID. Innova return ≈ ₹2,500.

• Night: Golden Temple lit up; dinner at Kesar da Dhaba / Bharawan da Dhaba; Amritsari kulcha for breakfast.

Stay: Airbnb Amritsar | **Day spend (per person):** ₹500 cab share + ₹700 food

Day 4 · Sun 27 Dec · Amritsar → Dalhousie

• Innova via Pathankot (~5 h). Afternoon: Gandhi Chowk, Mall Road, St John's Church, Subhash Baoli, Panchpula.

Stay: Airbnb Dalhousie | **Day spend (per person):** ₹1,000 Innova share + ₹700 food

Day 5 · Mon 28 Dec · Khajjiar · Kalatop · Dainkund (snow day)

• **Khajjiar** (22 km): deodar-ringed meadow with a lake, snow-covered in some late-December years. **Kalatop** sanctuary forest walk.

• **Dainkund peak / Pohlani Mata temple** (2,755 m, highest point around Dalhousie and the snowiest): 30–45 min walk from the road.

• Avoid driving the Khajjiar/Dainkund roads after dark (black ice).

Stay: Airbnb Dalhousie | **Day spend (per person):** ₹670 Innova share + ₹700 food

Day 6 · Tue 29 Dec · Dalhousie → McLeodganj

• ~4 h drive. **Tsuglagkhang** (Dalai Lama temple complex) and the Tibet Museum → **Bhagsunag falls** → **Dharamkot** cafés.

• Rent microspikes in McLeodganj/Dharamkot for tomorrow (₹150–250).

Stay: Airbnb McLeodganj / Dharamkot | **Day spend (per person):** ₹900 Innova share + ₹700 food

Day 7 · Wed 30 Dec · Triund ridge day hike

• Start 07:30 from **Galu Devi temple** (forest check post; ₹100 per person per day). ~7–9 km one way, 3–4 h up. Dhauladhar wall in snow.

• In heavy snow the trail closes for some weeks; Kangra police have at times required prior intimation for Triund. Check at the check post. Day hike only (camping rules keep changing). Turn back by 13:00.

Stay: Airbnb McLeodganj | **Day spend (per person):** ₹250 entry/taxi + ₹700 food

Day 8 · Thu 31 Dec · Norbulingka → Palampur tea → Baijnath → Bir (NYE)

• **Norbulingka Institute** (Tibetan arts) → **Kangra Fort** (optional) → **Palampur** tea gardens (Wah / Mann tea estates) → 9th-century **Baijnath temple** → **Bir**. Option: ride the Kangra toy train for one stretch.

• Bir: Tibetan colony, Chokling monastery, sunset at the landing site. NYE bonfire at the Airbnb.

Stay: Airbnb Bir | **Day spend (per person):** ₹850 Innova share + ₹300 entries + ₹900 food/NYE

Day 9 · Fri 1 Jan · Bir paragliding → overnight bus to Delhi

• **Tandem paragliding** from Billing (₹2,500–3,000, 15–20 min). Winter flights depend on the Billing road being clear of snow, so book with a registered operator and check that morning.

• Evening HRTC/private bus from Bir/Baijnath/Palampur to Delhi.

Stay: Overnight bus | **Day spend (per person):** ₹2,800 (optional) + ₹800–1,400 bus + ₹600 food

Day 10 · Sat 2 Jan · Delhi → Hyderabad

• Humayun's Tomb / Lodhi Garden → **16:00 12724**.

Stay: Train | **Day spend (per person):** ₹400 + ₹600 food

Day 11 · Sun 3 Jan · Home

• Hyderabad ~17:10.

Where you sleep: Airbnb picks for 6 (best-rated and budget)

Nights	Area	Best-rated pick	Budget pick	Est. Dec price, 6 people / night	≈ per person / night
1 (26 Dec)	Amritsar	**Cozy Condo 3BHK, 2 km from Golden Temple**: 4.99★ (89) · **Guest-fav 3BHK FamilyVilla** 4.97★ (60)	**Cozy 3 bedroom Apt** near Golden Temple (4.5★, 28)	₹4,000–6,500	₹650–1,100
2 (27–28 Dec)	Dalhousie	**Dalhousie Cottage, a 150-year-old British bungalow**: 2 BR, 6 guests, 4.92★ (25); the listing label says Nainital, so confirm the location · **The Garden Cottage, Panoramic Mountain Views** (sleeps 8, 4.58★, 40)	**Birdwood Cottages** guest-house rooms (book 3)	₹5,000–8,000	₹850–1,350
2 (29–30 Dec)	McLeodganj / Dharamkot	**Attic House with a Mountain View** (3 bed / 6 ppl): 4.77★ (125) · **Earthbound Homes Plus 3BHK** ~4.9★	**The Bougainvillea** entire floor, 3 BR / 6 (4.67★, 6) · **Just Homely 3BHK**, Dharamshala	₹5,000–8,000	₹850–1,350
1 (31 Dec)	Bir	**Workation-Bir-Billing** house: 4 rooms with attached baths, 6–8 guests · **Home in Bir**, independent 3BHK (6)	Private rooms in Bir hostels (Tibetan colony side)	₹4,000–7,000	₹650–1,150

Listing names, ratings and review counts come from Airbnb search results in Nov 2026. Airbnb blocks automated price checks, so the 'Dec price for 6' column is an **estimate** for an entire 3-bedroom place over the holiday week. Check the live total for your dates.

How to pick the best-rated vs the cheapest on Airbnb

Filters: Guests = 6 · Type of place = **Entire home** · Bedrooms ≥ 3 (or 2 + sofa-beds) · tick **Guest favourite** · toggle **'Display total before taxes'** so the price includes cleaning and service fees.

Best-rated vs cheapest: sort by price after setting the filters, then pick the cheapest listing with ≥ 4.7★ and ≥ 20 reviews. A 5.0★ with 3 reviews is not more reliable than a 4.8★ with 150.

Winter questions to message the host before booking: room heaters (some charge ₹300–500/night per heater), geyser/hot water, power backup, whether a car reaches the door (Old Manali, Vashisht, Jibhi and McLeodganj often have steep stairs), and snow-time access.

NYE rules: many hosts set a 2–3 night minimum for 30 Dec–1 Jan. Book those nights first with flexible or moderate cancellation.

Where Airbnb is thin (Zuluk, Aritar, Rinchenpong, Sari/Chopta, Sangla/Kalpa, Bandipur, Spiti), book homestays by phone or on Booking.com / MakeMyTrip. Usually 3 rooms × ₹1,500–3,000 with meals.

Places covered

Place	Type	Why
Golden Temple, Jallianwala Bagh, Partition Museum	Main	Punjab's heart; free langar
Attari–Wagah Beating Retreat	Main	Border ceremony
Dalhousie, Khajjiar	Main	Colonial hill town, 'mini Switzerland' meadow
Kalatop, Dainkund	Offbeat	Forest sanctuary, snowiest viewpoint
McLeodganj, Tsuglagkhang, Bhagsu	Main	Tibetan exile capital
Dharamkot, Triund ridge	Semi-offbeat	Cafés, ridge facing the Dhauladhar
Norbulingka, Palampur tea, Baijnath	Offbeat	Tibetan crafts, tea slopes, 9th-c. temple
Kangra Valley toy train	Offbeat	Restored narrow-gauge line (2026)
Bir–Billing	Semi-offbeat	Paragliding, monasteries

Bike / scooty rentals

Where	Rates	Notes
McLeodganj / Dharamshala	Scooty ₹500–800 · RE ₹1,200–1,800	Steep, narrow lanes; fine for Naddi / Bhagsu on dry days
Bir	Scooty ₹500–800	Handy for Bir colony and Baijnath. Billing road is steep: take the operator jeep
Amritsar	Scooty ₹400–600	City only. Wagah is easier by Innova

Winter gear: what to buy, what to rent, and where

Gear budget: if you own nothing warm, expect ₹4,000–6,500 one-time purchase (thermals, fleece, gloves, cap, socks, sunglasses) + ₹800–1,500 rentals on the trip. Plan budgets include only the rentals. Six people can share: buy 2 pairs of microspikes and 1 first-aid kit for the group instead of 6.

Item	Need	Buy (Decathlon Hyderabad / local)	Rent (where & rate)	Advice
Thermal inner set (top + bottom) ×2	Must	₹800–1,200 per set (local ₹400–600)	Not rented (hygiene)	Buy. Merino/poly, not cotton
Fleece / sweater (mid layer)	Must	₹600–1,200	—	Buy
Padded / down jacket (−5 to −10 °C)	Must	₹2,500–5,000	Indiahikes rentals ₹55–80/day (ships to you); trek operators ₹100/day; Manali / Gulmarg shops ₹150–300/day	Rent if you won't reuse it: 10 days ≈ ₹600–1,000
One-piece snow suit	Snow points	—	Solang/Palchan, Kufri, Gulmarg, Tsomgo ₹250–500/day (often with gumboots)	Rent on the spot
Gumboots / snow boots	Snow points	—	₹100–200/day (bundled with suit at Solang ₹400–500)	Rent on the spot
Waterproof trekking shoes	Treks	₹2,000–3,500 (Decathlon MH100/MH500)	Trek operators ₹100–150/day	Buy if you'll trek again
Waterproof gloves + woollen inners	Must	₹300–900 + ₹150	—	Buy
Woollen cap / balaclava / neck gaiter	Must	₹200–400 each	—	Buy

Item	Need	Buy (Decathlon Hyderabad / local)	Rent (where & rate)	Advice
Woollen socks (4 pairs)	Must	₹400–600	—	Buy
UV400 sunglasses	Snow	₹300–800	—	Prevents snow-blindness
Microspikes + gaiters	Treks / icy walks	₹1,200–1,800	Chopta/Sari/Sankri/Dharamkot ₹150–250/day; gaiters ₹100/day	Rent

Rental points on this route

Point	What you can rent	Rate
McLeodganj / Dharamkot / Galu	Microspikes, gaiters, poles, jackets	₹100–250 per item/day
Khajjiar / Dainkund stalls	Gumboots, snow suits (on snow days)	₹200–400
Bir operators	Jackets for the flight (usually included)	Included
Indiahikes rentals (online)	Padded jacket, trek shoes	₹55–150/day

Budget per person (6 people sharing)

Item (per person, 6 sharing)	Shoestring	Recommended	Notes
Train Hyderabad → Delhi (12723)	₹800	₹2,100	SL vs 3A
Delhi day (metro, cloak room, entries)	₹400	₹500	
Delhi → Amritsar overnight	₹350	₹350	SL (3A ≈ ₹950)
Amritsar local + Wagah border Innova	₹500	₹500	≈ ₹3,000 ÷ 6
Innova legs: Amritsar→Dalhousie, Khajjiar–Dainkund day, Dalhousie→McLeodganj, McLeodganj→Palampur→Bir	₹3,450	₹3,450	≈ ₹20.6k ÷ 6
Triund entry + Galu taxi	₹250	₹250	₹100 forest fee + shared taxi
Bir paragliding (optional)	₹0	₹2,800	₹2,500–3,000 tandem, weather permitting
Bir / Palampur → Delhi overnight bus	₹800	₹1,400	HRTC ordinary vs Volvo
Delhi half-day on 2 Jan	₹300	₹400	
Train Delhi → Hyderabad (12724)	₹800	₹2,100	SL vs 3A
Airbnb: Amritsar 1N, Dalhousie 2N, McLeodganj 2N, Bir 1N (NYE)	₹4,800	₹7,350	Entire 3BR homes ÷ 6
Food (Golden Temple langar is free)	₹5,000	₹5,500	
Entries (Partition Museum, Norbulingka, Kangra Fort)	₹300	₹500	
Gear rentals (spikes for Triund)	₹600	₹800	
Buffer	₹800	₹1,000	
TOTAL per person	**₹19,150**	**₹29,000**	**Fits ₹25–30k even with paragliding and 3A on the long trains.**

Bookings to do now

- 12724 return (2 Jan) → 12723 onward (24 Dec) → Delhi → Amritsar overnight (25 Dec).
- Airbnb Bir (31 Dec) and McLeodganj first, then Dalhousie and Amritsar.
- Innova for the 4 Himachal legs from one Pathankot/Dharamshala operator (fixed price in writing). Bir → Delhi bus for 1 Jan.

- Paragliding with a registered Bir operator (pay on the day only if they fly).

Plan B

- Dense fog in Amritsar (common late Dec) delays trains. If the Delhi–Amritsar train is very late, keep Wagah and do the Golden Temple at night.
- Khajjiar/Dainkund roads iced: go to Chamera lake (lower) or stay in Dalhousie town and walk Kalatop.
- Triund closed: Naddi viewpoint + Dal lake (McLeod) + Gallu temple walk, or the Bhagsu–Shiva café trail.
- No paragliding (snow/wind): Barot valley day trip from Bir (offbeat) or Sherabling monastery.

Carry list

- Original photo ID (Aadhaar/DL) + 2 photocopies + **4 passport photos** each (Sikkim/Bhutan permits, J&K checks). **Nepal: passport or voter ID** (Aadhaar is generally not accepted).
- Power bank (cold halves battery life), offline maps, ₹5–8k cash each (ATMs fail in snow areas).
- Group med kit: paracetamol, ORS, cold/cough tablets, band-aids, Vaseline, motion-sickness tablets (hill roads). Diamox only on a doctor's advice.
- Thermos for hot water, quick-dry towel, plastic bags for wet gear, a 3-pin multi-plug for the Airbnb (one socket per room is common).
- Prepaid SIMs from outside J&K don't work in Kashmir. Carry at least 2 postpaid connections in the group (Plan 3).

Safety & buffers

- Roads and snow change by the hour. Check state police traffic updates and ask your host each evening. Emergency: **112**. HP disaster helpline: **1077**.
- No two-wheelers on fresh snow or black ice. Taxis with chains are safer after snowfall.
- Book 30 Dec–1 Jan stays first (NYE rates 2–3×). Prefer flexible cancellation.
- Start the last long leg (hills → Delhi/railhead) by 1 Jan. NYE traffic and snow delay buses 3–8 h.

Sources checked

Reddit and direct page fetches (Airbnb, IRCTC, erail, ConfirmTkt) were blocked from this environment, so everything here comes from web-search results: Airbnb listing snippets, rail timetable aggregators, Team-BHP, Tripoto, travel blogs and local news. Live seat availability and live prices could not be checked; use the checklists above to verify.

— Triund fee (₹100) and rules: The Tribune (fee cut), thetravellertrails (Jan 2026), Curly Tales (Kangra trekking rules), vargiskhan (camping)
— Bir paragliding prices & winter flying: trekgo, Thrillophilia, WanderOn, Outlook Traveller
— Kangra Valley toy train restored (June 2026): Outlook Traveller, Curly Tales, Keekli, The Tribune
— Khajjiar/Dalhousie snow & Dainkund: TravelTriangle, JustWravel, The Hosteller; Amritsar–Dalhousie taxi: cabbazar, oneway.cab, exploreindia
— Airbnb listings: airbnb.com/.co.in Amritsar, Dalhousie, McLeod Ganj, Dharamshala, Bir pages via search (Nov 2026)
— Golden Temple Mail 12903 route: Wikipedia mirror, totaltraininfo (Delhi times not confirmed)